

The Salon Booking-Enquiry Checklist

Seven questions that turn “can I book nails tomorrow?” into a booking your reception can confirm in one message, safe replies for price, bridal and first-time colour questions, how to handle client photos and numbers, and a weekly scorecard. Everything here works with the free WhatsApp Business app.

1. Why the first reply matters

Salon booking requests arrive on WhatsApp and Instagram in the evening, after closing and on weekends, and many clients message more than one salon. In Harvard Business Review's study of online sales leads, firms that contacted a lead within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify it as firms that waited longer. The faster a complete request reaches your reception, the more likely the slot is still yours.

Source: J. Oldroyd, K. McElheran, D. Elkington, “The Short Life of Online Sales Leads”, Harvard Business Review, March 2011 — hbr.org/2011/03/the-short-life-of-online-sales-leads

2. The 7-question intake

Ask these in the first reply. Together they let reception offer a real slot and the right staff member without three rounds of back-and-forth.

#	Ask	Why it matters
1	Which service? (hair cut/colour/treatment, nails, brows/lashes/waxing, makeup/bridal, massage/spa)	Sets the appointment length and which staff member is needed.
2	Is this about a reaction after a recent treatment (itching, burning, swelling, rash)?	Goes to the manager at once; severe symptoms get 998 (section 4).
3	Preferred day and time, plus one alternative	One confirmation message instead of three.
4	In the salon or a home service? If home: which area?	Home visits depend on travel time and area charges your team sets.
5	How many people? (bridal and group bookings)	Groups need several staff at once; bridal often needs a trial.
6	First time with us, or a returning client? First-time colour or lash tint?	Your colour or lash product may require a patch test first.
7	Name for the booking, and English or Arabic	Book under the right name and match the staff member who replies.

Copy-paste intake message (WhatsApp quick reply)

Thank you for contacting [Salon]! To book you in, please send: 1) the service, 2) preferred day and time (and one alternative), 3) salon or home service — if home, which area, 4) how many people, 5) first visit or returning, 6) your name. Reception will confirm the time, staff member and price by [time]. Your booking is confirmed only when we reply to confirm it.

3. Safe replies to the questions that come up most

Question	Reply pattern	Why
“How much is gel / keratin?”	Quote only the prices on your current, published price list. If it depends on hair length or design, say so and confirm before the appointment.	A price typed in a hurry becomes a price the client expects at the till.
“Any offers?”	Share only offers your manager has signed off, with their end date. Don't invent discounts in chat.	Avoids disputes and inconsistent pricing between staff.
“Can you come to my home?”	Confirm the area, travel charge (if any) and timing before booking. Offer home service only if your trade licence and permits cover it.	Home service is a different operation; check what your licence allows.

Question	Reply pattern	Why
"Bridal makeup and henna for 5"	Collect date, location, number of people and whether a trial is wanted, then hand to the manager.	High-value bookings deserve a person, not a template.
"Is my 7pm confirmed?"	Only "yes" if it is actually in your booking book or system; otherwise "reception will confirm by [time]".	An automatic "confirmed" for a slot that isn't free costs you the client.

4. Safety lines for every reply (staff or automated)

- **First-time colour:** many hair-dye makers ask for an allergy test before colouring; the UK NHS advises testing the dye at least 48 hours before use. Tell first-time colour clients at booking, so the test fits before the appointment — follow your own product's instructions.
- **Black henna:** the NHS notes that "black henna" tattoo paste can contain high levels of PPD, which raises the risk of a reaction to hair dye later. Ask about it if your colourist requires it.
- **Reactions go to a person at once.** Messages about swelling of the face, lips or tongue, or trouble breathing get one reply: call 998 (UAE ambulance) or go to the nearest emergency department now. Milder irritation: see a doctor or pharmacist, and the manager calls back.
- **No medical advice in chat.** Replies collect details and give your salon's information; they don't diagnose or recommend treatments.

Source: NHS, "Hair dye reactions" — nhs.uk/conditions/hair-dye-reactions/. General information, not medical advice.

5. Client numbers and photos

- **Ask before you message for marketing.** UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 (Personal Data Protection Law) generally requires the person's consent to process their personal data, and gives them the right to correct it or to restrict or stop its processing. Keep booking messages and promotional broadcasts separate, and remove anyone who asks.
- **Before-and-after photos need permission.** Get the client's clear, written OK before a photo of their hair, nails or face is posted, and use real, unedited results.
- **Ask your chat or AI vendor** where messages are stored, who can read them and how to delete a client's data on request.

Source: UAE Government portal, "Data protection laws" — u.ae/en/about-the-uae/digital-uae/data/data-protection-laws. General information, not legal advice.

6. Set this up today in the free WhatsApp Business app

- **Away message after closing:** Tools → Away message → turn on "Send away message", paste the intake message from section 2, and choose "Outside of business hours" (set your business hours first). Clients who message at 11pm then send a complete request instead of "hi?".
- **Quick replies:** save the intake message, your price-list link, your location and the home-service areas as quick replies, so every staff member sends the same accurate answer.
- **Lists / labels:** sort chats into "New request", "Waiting to confirm", "Bridal", "Confirmed" and "Follow up", so nothing sits unanswered over the weekend.

Sources: WhatsApp Help Center, "How to use away messages" — faq.whatsapp.com/2565868990219715; WhatsApp Business, "Staying organized ... using Lists and quick replies" — whatsappbusiness.com/resources.

7. Weekly scorecard (10 minutes every Monday)

Number	How to count it
Booking requests received	New WhatsApp / Instagram DM / website requests this week
Received after closing	How many arrived outside your opening hours
Replied within 1 hour	% answered within 60 minutes, including evenings and weekends
Complete requests	% with service, time, salon/home and name after the first exchange
Bookings confirmed	Requests that became a confirmed appointment
Bridal / group enquiries	How many, and how many reached the manager the same day

8. Want to see this working on your own enquiries?

Try our sample assistant for a fictional salon: mountainai-ae.com/demo/beauty-salon-assistant.html. It asks the questions above in English or Arabic, never confirms a booking or a price on its own, sends bridal requests to the manager and flags reactions as urgent.

Free demo in 24 hours, built from your salon's website or price list, private link. → **14-day pilot AED 1,500**, live on your WhatsApp Business number or website, credited in full if you continue. → **Full setup AED 7,500 + AED 1,250/month** (hosting, monitoring, monthly updates; Meta WhatsApp fees billed to you directly). We don't promise a number of bookings — the pilot report shows what actually happened.

Reply **DEMO** on WhatsApp +971 56 777 3366 or email info@mountainai-ae.com.